

A POINTCAST ADVENTURE · EL SEGUNDO, CALIFORNIA

SIGNAL over the SOUTH BAY

BRAND BOOK & STYLE GUIDE

Issue No. 1 · "The Lantern Goes Dark" · Volume 1 · October 2026

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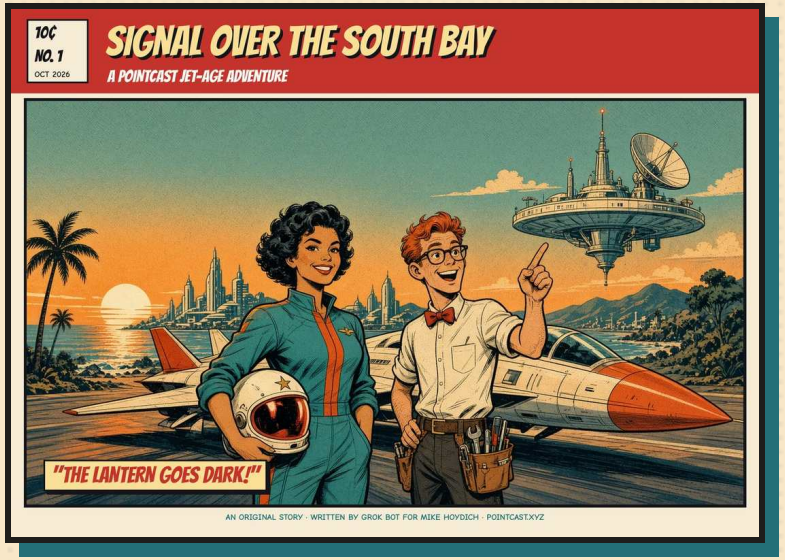
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Edition A cover, landscape pass. This book uses both art passes: **Edition A** (landscape, lettered in post) and **Edition B** (portrait, painted lettering).



Tomorrow, the way 1962 pictured it

02 BRAND STORY & MISSION

El Segundo builds tomorrow. It always has: the aircraft plants, the rocket shops, the long beach where the test pilots surfed on weekends. Signal Over the South Bay takes that real heritage and turns the dial forward to the future the jet age promised.

Above the bay floats **the Lantern**, a broadcast station that sends the town its morning paper (weather, tides, swell and news) to every beach-house radio at 6:45 sharp. When it goes dark before dawn, test pilot **Capt. Della Marsh** and station engineer **Rusty Vance** fly the rocket-plane **the Gull** out of the Aero Works to turn the dish back toward home, by hand.

The series is PointCast's own original serial: a local publication's love letter to its town, told as a Silver Age adventure. Nobody is punched. Problems get solved with wrenches, nerve and a good signal.

Mission

To make El Segundo's past feel like a promise: bright, brave, neighborly adventures where the hero's job is to keep the community connected.

01 · JET-AGE OPTIMISM

The future is sunny, streamlined and worth building. Danger is real, but the tone is never cynical.

02 · LOCAL SIGNAL

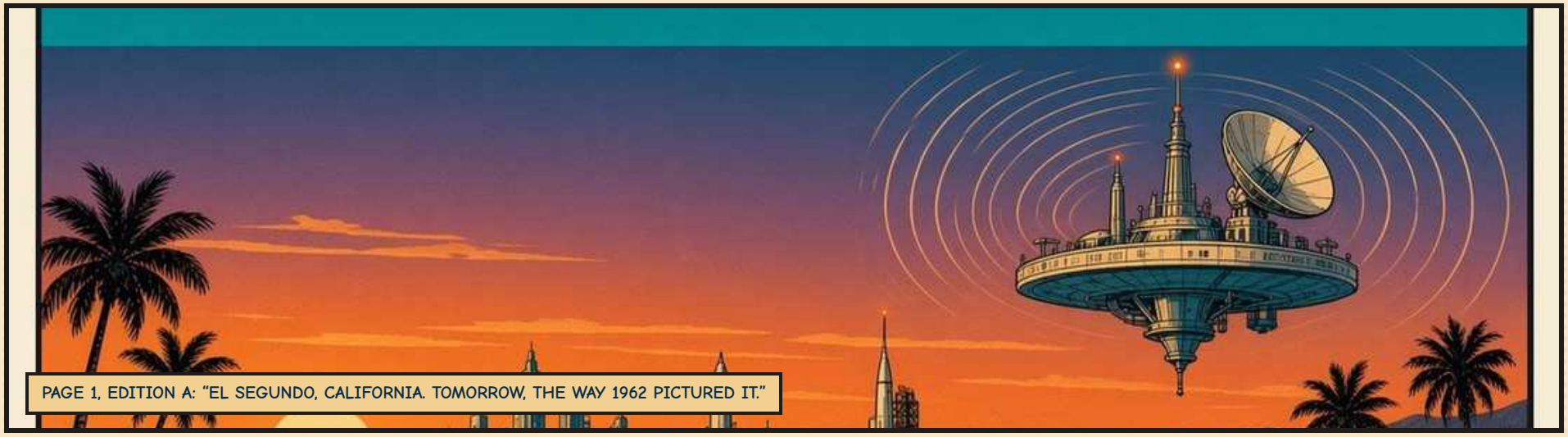
Every story starts and ends in the South Bay: the pier, the refinery lights, the runway, the beach.

03 · HANDS-ON HEROES

Pilots and engineers win by competence and teamwork, not superpowers.

04 · THE PAPER GETS THROUGH

The stakes are communal: the morning edition, the town's shared clock.



PAGE 1, EDITION A: "EL SEGUNDO, CALIFORNIA. TOMORROW, THE WAY 1962 PICTURED IT."

The primary mark

03 LOGO & MASTHEAD LOCKUP



ANATOMY

1. **The Lantern mast.** The I of SIGNAL carries a needle mast and a beacon with broadcast arcs. It is the one custom glyph and must never be dropped.
2. **SIGNAL.** Heavy rounded display caps, forward-leaning 9°, Gull Orange with a Navy contour, a 13-unit block shadow and a Paper White inline.
3. **"over the".** Jet-age script in Visor Red, riding a contrail ribbon that ends in an arrowhead, the Gull's flight path.
4. **SOUTH BAY.** Same caps in Lantern Teal. Always smaller than SIGNAL (about 70%).

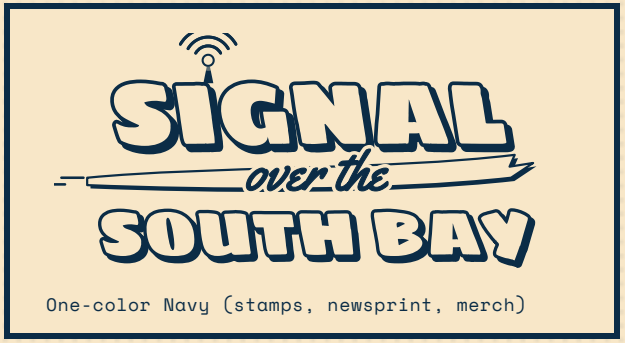
CLEAR SPACE & SIZE

Keep clear space equal to the height of the **S** in SOUTH BAY on all sides. Minimum width: **1.5 in** in print, **240 px** on screen. Below that, use the horizontal lockup or the Lantern icon.

All lettering is converted to outlines, so the SVGs render the same everywhere with no fonts installed.



Reversed, on South Bay Navy



One-color Navy (stamps, newsprint, merch)



Reversed, on Lantern Teal

THE LOGO FAMILY



"A POINTCAST ADVENTURE" SEAL

Round seal for covers, thumbnails, end pages and merch. Top corner of the cover, or the bottom-right of a poster. Minimum 0.6 in or 72 px.



Banner badge. The cover line ribbon ("A POINTCAST ADVENTURE"). Runs across the foot of a cover or the top of a feature page. Always horizontal, never arched.



Horizontal masthead. For page headers, the PointCast feature banner and 2×1 blocks. The mast stays on the I.



Lantern icon. Avatar, favicon, block 1×1 fallback and social profile. Works down to 32 px.

FILE (ASSETS/)	USE	FILE (ASSETS/)	USE
masthead-primary.svg	Light grounds, covers	badge-pointcast-adventure.svg	Round seal
masthead-reversed.svg	Navy, teal, dark art	badge-pointcast-adventure-banner.svg	Cover-line ribbon
masthead-mono.svg	One-color print	icon-lantern.svg	Avatar, favicon
masthead-horizontal.svg	Headers, wide blocks	All SVGs are outlined vector, sRGB, transparent backgrounds (the icon has its own tile).	

04

Sampled from the art, not invented

COLOR PALETTE

Every value below was measured from the finished art with PIL: all 22 images (both comic editions and the six posters) were tiled, quantized to 32 colors (median cut + k-means), and the nearest sampled cluster was taken for each role. These are the colors the art actually prints, faded newsprint included.

Core five

LANTERN TEAL
#236F77
RGB 35 111 119
CMYK≈ 71 7 0 53

GULL ORANGE
#EF6E1E
RGB 239 110 30
CMYK≈ 0 54 87 6

NEWSPRINT CREAM
#F3DBB1
RGB 243 219 177
CMYK≈ 0 10 27 5

VISOR RED
#D23D1B
RGB 210 61 27
CMYK≈ 0 71 87 18

SOUTH BAY NAVY
#0B2C46
RGB 11 44 70
CMYK≈ 84 37 0 73

Support six

BRUSH INK
#1E1D1B
RGB 30 29 27
CMYK≈ 0 3 10 88

PAPER WHITE
#F8E7C8
RGB 248 231 200
CMYK≈ 0 7 19 3

CAPTION GOLD
#F1D091
RGB 241 208 145
CMYK≈ 0 14 40 5

SURF TEAL
#43959B
RGB 67 149 155
CMYK≈ 57 4 0 39

SUNSET AMBER
#ED9647
RGB 237 150 71
CMYK≈ 0 37 70 7

DEEP SPACE
#051F2B
RGB 5 31 43
CMYK≈ 88 28 0 83

CMYK values are a naive conversion for reference only. Proof on uncoated stock before a print run. Script: `src/palette.py` → `src/palette.json`.

04

Proportion, pairing, contrast

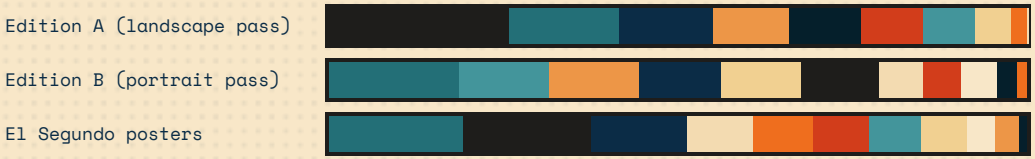
COLOR IN USE

THE 60 / 25 / 10 / 5 RULE



Brand layouts (feature pages, posters, merch) sit on cream or paper. Navy and teal carry type and structure. Orange is the spark: the beacon, the nose cone, the sun. Red is a pinch: the visor, the bow tie, the fins, the price box.

WHAT THE ART REALLY HOLDS



Share of downsampled pixels nearest to each brand color. Edition A runs darker (more ink and deep space); Edition B and the posters carry more cream and gold. Lay out with that in mind: the navy pages need cream type.

COLOR STORIES

Dusk · El Segundo at sundown, pages 1 & 7

Orbit · night sky and space, pages 2, 5 & 6

Hangar · machines and work lights, page 3

APPROVED PAIRINGS (WCAG CONTRAST, COMPUTED)

Aa
South Bay Navy on Paper White
11.8:1 · AAA

Aa
Paper White on South Bay Navy
11.8:1 · AAA

Aa
Brush Ink on Caption Gold
11.4:1 · AAA

Aa
South Bay Navy on Gull Orange
4.7:1 · AA

Aa
Paper White on Lantern Teal
4.8:1 · AA

Aa
Brush Ink on Newsprint Cream
12.5:1 · AAA

Aa
Paper White on Visor Red
3.9:1 · AA large

Aa
Gull Orange on Lantern Teal
1.9:1 · Decor only

Body text needs AA (4.5:1) or better. Orange on teal is for shapes and big display only, never text.

05

Free Google Fonts, jet-age voices

TYPOGRAPHY

Masthead & display · **Sigmar One**

SIGNAL BOOSTED!

Logo base, cover titles, poster numbers. 40 pt and up, caps, lean −9° only in the masthead.

Jet-age script · **Yellowtail**

over the South Bay

Connective words and kickers (“over the”, “featuring”). Never more than four words. Never all caps.

Headline · **Bebas Neue**

EL SEGUNDO AERO WORKS · ISSUE NO. 1

Section heads, poster place names, UI labels. Track +40 to +120.

Body · **Jost**

The Lantern sends the town its paper (weather, tides, swell and news) at 6:45 every morning. *Jost Italic* for asides.

Geometric midcentury sans for running text, decks and the PointCast block dek. 400 / 600, 10–12 pt.

Lettering · **Comic Neue Bold** + **Bangers**

THEN STRAP IN, MR. VANCE!

WHOOOSH!

Comic Neue Bold, all caps, for every caption and balloon. Bangers only for SFX and cover lines.

Teletype · **Space Mono**

4:12 A.M. · NO CARRIER · #236F77

Timestamps, radio transcripts, hex values, credits and data. Never for dialogue.

PAIRING RULES

1. Max **three families** on one surface: one display (Sigmar or Bebas), one text (Jost), one utility (Space Mono or Comic Neue).
2. **Sigmar + Yellowtail** only meet inside a lockup, with the script smaller and in a contrasting color.
3. **Bebas over Jost** is the default editorial pair: Bebas head at 2.5–3× the Jost body size.
4. **Comic Neue never leaves the panel.** Outside the comic, character quotes set in Jost Italic.

06

Keep them exactly consistent

CHARACTERS



Capt. Della Marsh

TEST PILOT · EL SEGUNDO AERO WORKS

- Early 30s · short dark curly hair · warm brown skin · confident grin
- **Teal flight suit** with one bold **orange chest stripe**
- **White helmet, red visor, small gold star**

Voice: clipped, warm, decisive. She gives the order and then the joke.

"THEN THE MORNING EDITION GOES NOWHERE. WAKE UP THE GULL."



Edition A model · p. 3



Rusty Vance

RADIO ENGINEER · THE LANTERN

- Lanky · freckled · red hair · **black horn-rimmed glasses**
- **Cream short-sleeved shirt, red bow tie**, leather tool belt
- In space: **silver bubble helmet** over a cream pressure suit

Voice: fast, proud, a little indignant. Counts down out loud.

"YOU'RE NOT FIXING MY DISH WITHOUT ME. I BUILT HALF OF THAT THING!"



Edition A model · p. 3

Model rules: Della is always in teal and Rusty in cream, so the pair reads as a complementary set. Della's stripe runs **horizontally across the chest** in Edition B and as a vertical placket stripe in Edition A. Pick one per issue and hold it. Rusty's bow tie is the only red on him. Neither character ever carries a weapon.

The hardware is a character too

06 VEHICLES & PLACES



The Gull

DELLA'S ROCKET-PLANE

Cream fuselage, swept delta wings, orange nose cone, red tail fins. A bubble canopy for two. Always drawn nose-up or level, never diving, with a clean flame column and a cream contrail.



The Lantern

BROADCAST STATION IN THE SKY

Cream-and-teal saucer ring, tall needle mast, big round dish, and a soft **orange beacon** at the crown. It is always visible in the sky on an El Segundo page. Dark beacon = trouble.



The Aero Works hangar · Edition A, p. 3



The Gull alongside the wounded Lantern · Edition A, p. 5



Launch over the pier · Edition A, p. 4

One page, one panel, one big idea

07 PANEL RULES



C Cover



1 The town that builds tomorrow



2 The signal drops



3 Rusty signs on



4 Launch



5 The Lantern, wounded



6 The spacewalk



7 Morning edition

Edition A · the same beats, landscape

















FORMAT

- **One panel per page**, splash-style. Cover plus 7 pages per issue.
- **Edition B · portrait 2:3** (1024×1536 master), the print and phone read.
- **Edition A · landscape 16:9** art in a cream frame with a running head and folio (2672 px wide), the desktop read.

DRAWING

- Thick confident outer contours; thinner interior line.
- **Flat color, no gradients**, except printed halftone dot texture and the beacon glow.
- Slightly aged newsprint ground. Never pure white, never pure black skies (use Deep Space).

STAGING

- The Lantern or its beacon appears on every Earth-side page.
- Horizon on a third; motion flows **left → right, low → high**.
- Every page has one clear silhouette that reads at thumbnail size.

07

Caption boxes, balloons, SFX

LETTERING RULES



CAPTION	Caption Gold box (#F1D091), 3 px Brush Ink rule, 4 px hard offset shadow, square corners. Narration, time and place.
BALLOON	Paper White oval, 3 px ink, one tapered tail aimed at the speaker's mouth. Dialogue only.
RADIO	Balloon with a dashed (broadcast) border and a lightning tail. The Lantern and PointCast speak this way.
SFX	Bangers, Gull Orange with a Navy outline, tilted −6° to −12°. One per page, max.



Edition A, page 2: caption top-left, balloons in reading order, tails clear of faces.

RULES

- **ALL CAPS**, Comic Neue Bold, sentence punctuation. Bold-italic for stressed words ("…***MARK!***").
- **≤ 25 words** per balloon, **≤ 3** balloons + 2 captions per page.
- Reading order: top-left to bottom-right; captions above balloons.
- Never cover a face, the Lantern, or the Gull's nose.
- Spell-check every lettered page. Generated art lettering is re-checked by hand.
- The end card is always "THE END… of the beginning!"

El Segundo, abstracted

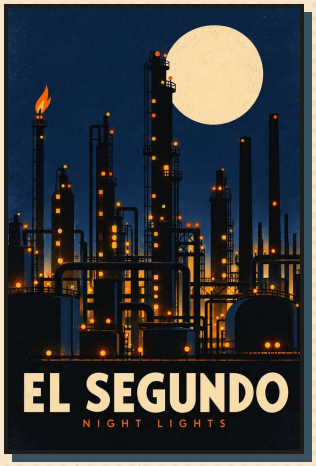
08 POSTER SERIES SYSTEM



ES-01 Sunset · Dockweiler Shore



ES-02 Aerospace City



ES-03 Night Lights



ES-04 Final Approach



ES-05 Main Street · Rec Park



ES-06 PointCast · On the Air



THE SYSTEM

- **2:3 portrait**, 1024×1536 master; prints at 12×18 in and 24×36 in.
- **One hero shape** (sun, rocket, refinery, airliners, water tower, radio mast) built from flat geometry. No characters: posters are the place, the comic is the people.
- **EL SEGUNDO** in a heavy slab or rounded caps across the foot, with a spaced subtitle naming a real landmark or mood.
- **4–5 brand colors** per poster. Cream or navy ground; orange sun is the series' signature.
- Number every poster ES-NN. ES-06 ties back to the comic: the broadcast mast and rings.
- Grain and slight print fade, never glossy.
- Chips under each poster: its four dominant brand colors, measured with PIL.

TYPE SPEC

EL SEGUNDO: Sigmar One, caps, width = 80% of the poster, baseline at 88% height. Cream on dark grounds, Navy on cream.

Subtitle: Bebas Neue, tracking +200, 1/6 the headline size, Gull Orange or Surf Teal, separated by a middle dot.

NEXT IN THE SERIES

ES-07 THE PIER · LOW TIDE
ES-08 GRAND AVENUE · SUMMER NIGHTS
ES-09 THE AERO WORKS · LANTERN DAWN
ES-10 THE RUNWAY · NIGHT MAIL

09

Sunny, competent, neighborly

VOICE & TONE

OPTIMISTIC, NOT NAIVE.

The meteor shower is real; so is the fix.

LOCAL, NOT TOURISTY.

Name real places: the pier, Dockweiler, Main Street, the Aero Works.

PUNCHY, NOT SHOUTY.

Short sentences. One exclamation mark per line, max.

PERIOD FLAVOR, MODERN VALUES.

Jet-age diction ("Mr. Vance", "on the dot"), today's cast and respect.

SPECIFIC NUMBERS.

4:12 A.M., ninety seconds, two degrees. Precision is the heroism.

SAY	NOT
"Then we turn it back toward home. By hand."	~~"Time to save the world!"~~
"A PointCast Adventure"	~~"The ultimate epic saga"~~
"The Lantern's gone dark."	~~"DISASTER STRIKES!!!"~~

OUR WORDS

signal · carrier · the morning edition · on the dot · the Aero Works · the Gull · the Lantern · South Bay · swell · strap in · mark

NOT OUR WORDS

superhero · villain · epic · universe · reboot · crossover · franchise · destroy · "literally"

Example taglines

1. "TOMORROW, THE WAY 1962 PICTURED IT."
2. "THE MORNING EDITION ALWAYS GETS THROUGH."
3. "BUILT IN EL SEGUNDO. BROADCAST TO THE STARS."
4. "FLY OUT. FIX IT. BRING IT HOME."
5. "EVERY BEACH-HOUSE RADIO. 6:45 ON THE DOT."
6. "HOLD ONTO YOUR BOW TIE!"
7. "TWO DEGREES… ONE… MARK!"
8. "SURF'S TWO TO THREE FEET, SKIES CLEAR, AND THE PAPER IS ON TIME."

`BLOCK DEK · ≤ 40 words`

A jet-age comic in a cover and seven pages: the broadcast station in the sky goes dark before dawn, and a test pilot and an engineer fly out of El Segundo to bring the morning edition home.

Guard the signal

10 DO'S & DON'TS



✓ Primary on cream with clear space



× Don't stretch or squash



× Don't recolor outside the palette



× Don't set the primary on busy art; use reversed + a navy band



× Don't rotate (the lean is built in)

Do

- Use the sampled hex values and the six named fonts.
- Show the Lantern or its beacon on every Earth-side image.
- Keep Della in teal and Rusty in cream, every time.
- Credit the PointCast Adventure seal on covers and end cards.
- Let El Segundo landmarks anchor every story and poster.
- Write alt text for every page and poster.

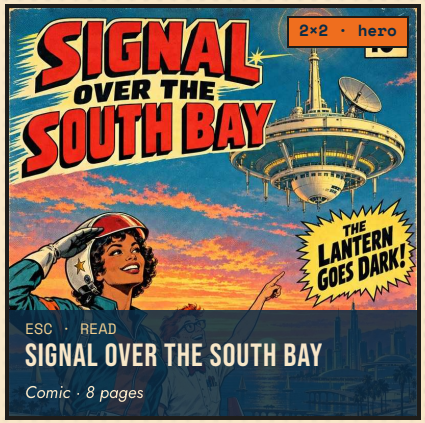
Don't

- Reference other publishers, their characters or real artists, or imitate any existing trade dress.
- Add gradients, chrome, lens flare or glossy 3D.
- Give the heroes weapons, or make the conflict about villains.
- Use real company logos, brands or trademarks in the art.
- Set body copy in Sigmar, Bangers or Yellowtail.
- Publish generated pages without a lettering and spelling check.

Blocks, thumbnails, social crops

11 USAGE ON POINTCAST

BLOCK TILES









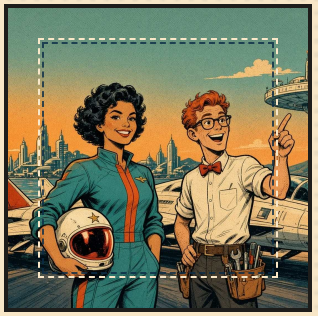


- **2×2** uses the Edition B cover, top-weighted crop, as `media.src`. Title bar in Navy at 85% with Bebas title.
- **2×1** uses the Edition A cover art (landscape); **1×2** uses a portrait page; **1×1** crops to one silhouette (the Gull or the Lantern) or falls back to the icon.
- Channel `ESC`, type `READ`, tags `comic · el-segundo · jet-age · retro-future`. Cover WebP is also the `ogImage`.

SOCIAL CROPS (SAFE ZONES DASHED)



`OG / link card · 1200×630`



`Square · 1080×1080`



`Feed 4:5 · 1080×1350`



`Story 9:16 · 1080×1920`

- Keep faces, the masthead and the beacon inside the central **80%** safe zone; stories keep the top and bottom 14% clear for UI.
- Thumbnails must read at **160 px**: one silhouette, high contrast, no small lettering.
- Export WebP for the site (quality 82), JPG for social. sRGB always.



The morning edition always gets through.

SIGNAL over the SOUTH BAY

CREDITS

Series created and published by **Michael Hoydich** for PointCast (pointcast.xyz), El Segundo, California.
Script & lettering: Grok Bot.
Edition A art: Grok Imagine image generation, landscape pass.
Edition B art: ChatGPT image generation, portrait pass.
El Segundo poster series ES-01 to ES-06.
All characters, vehicles and the Lantern station are original. No licensed characters or marks.

FONTS (SIL OPEN FONT LICENSE)

Sigmar One · Yellowtail · Bebas Neue · Jost · Comic Neue · Bangers · Space Mono. All free on Google Fonts; copies in `fonts/`.

FILES

`brand-book.pdf` · `brand-book.html` · `cover.png`
`assets/*.svg` (7 logo files)
`src/` `logos.py` · `palette.py` · `palette.json` · `build.py`

Brand book v1.0 · October 2026 · Internal. Not for publication.